POE PART 1- Research

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I hereby declare that I did not plagiarize the content of this assignment and that this is my own work.

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Research Report

Introduction

The following report will be discussing 3 budgeting apps namely: MyMoney, Spendee and Cashew. The report will include the overview of each app followed by screenshots with descriptions of how the interface functions. Strengths and Weakness list assist in helping us deduce which app is worth utilising. A description of the innovative features will inform us of how functional they are, allowing us to note the best features from each that we would like to implement in our app.

1. MyMoney App

Overview

The My Money budgeting app helps keep track and budget their money. You can set budgets for specific categories (car, education, food etc.), add different accounts (savings, cash, credit), and visually analyse your income and expenses with charts/graphs (Raha, 2025). These tools work together to help users budget efficiently (Raha, 2025).

Screenshots with descriptions

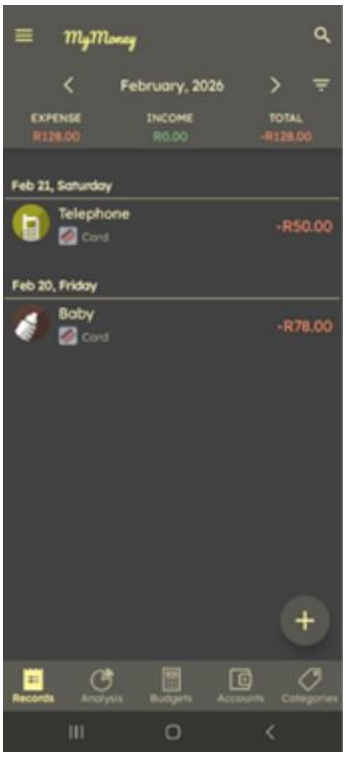


Figure 1: Records Screen



Figure 2: Adding Transaction



Figure 3: Category List

This is the home screen; it gives an overview of the most recent transactions and allows the user to add a transaction by pressing the "+" icon. The initial layout is simple which is less confusing. When entering a transaction, you can pick which account its coming from, even cash. You can also create your own categories for spending and budgeting.



Figure 4:Analysis Screen

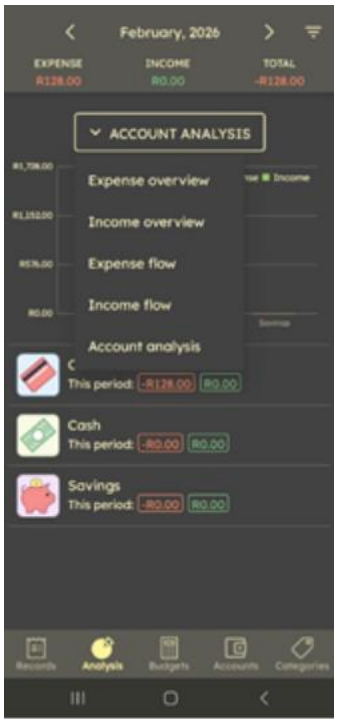


Figure 5:Analyse Income or Expense

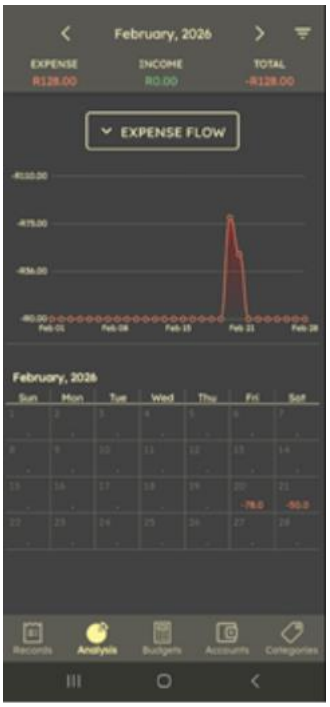


Figure 6:Calendar & Graph breakdown

In the analysis tab, the user can view their financial data through multiple visual formats like pie chart or bar/line graphs. The layout is clean and uncluttered, allowing users to quickly interpret their financial habits at a glance. They can reflect on their financial habits daily and choose any day on the calendar they would like a detailed analysis on.

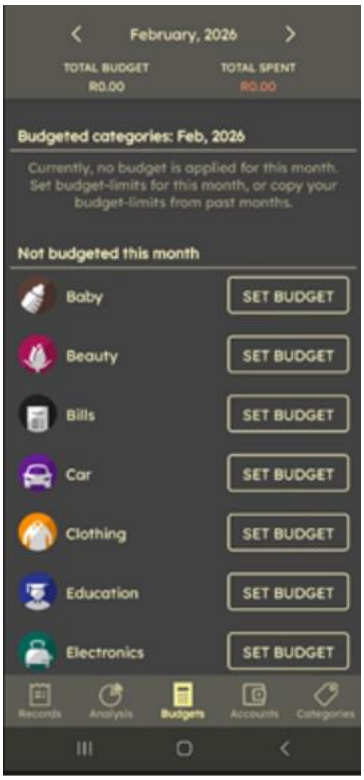


Figure 7:Budget Screen

In the budgets tab, you can set a monthly spending limit for each category. The app tracks your expenses against these limits and displays your remaining budget.

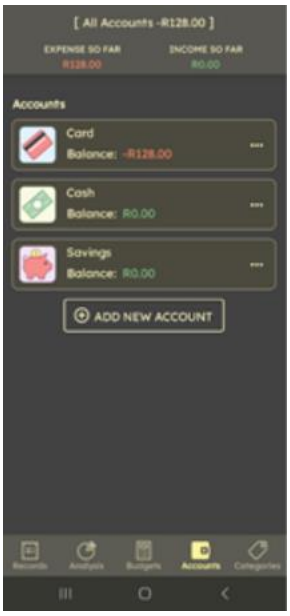


Figure 8:Account Screen

In the Accounts tab, you can create, delete, and manage your different account, each with their own balance and analysis.

Strengths

- The app is fully offline, no internet is required (Weber, 2022)
- Simple and easy to learn UI (Pareek, 2022)
- Detailed expense and income analysis (Pareek, 2022)
- Multiple accounts for managing wallet, cards, savings (Pareek, 2022)

Weaknesses

- There is no option for automatic recurring transactions (Pareek, 2022)
- Lacks advanced features used in recent apps likes investment tracking (Weber, 2025).
- Free version has significantly less features than the paid version (Weber, 2025)

Innovative features

Multiple Accounts

You can easily manage multiple accounts like savings, cards, credit, and wallet etc. (Pareek, 2022).

Customize Categories

Able to create and customize categories (Weber, 2025). Users have existing categories to choose from, and users can adjust them to their liking (Weber, 2025).

Deep Analysis

The analysis of expenses and income is very detailed, allowing output through various types of charts/graphs to promote better spending habits (Weber, 2025).

Offline Backup

Due to offline capability, the data ca be stored in a folder on the users' device. If the app is reinstalled later, then the user can upload that folder to avoid the initial app setup process again (Pareek, 2022).

2. Spendee App

Overview

According to Lahiri (2026) Spendee is a personal finance application designed for individuals and small-medium sized businesses. It helps users manage their finances efficiently by providing practical tools to track spending and monitor budgets. Spendee prioritises user-friendliness and accessibility (Lahiri, 2026).

Screenshots with descriptions

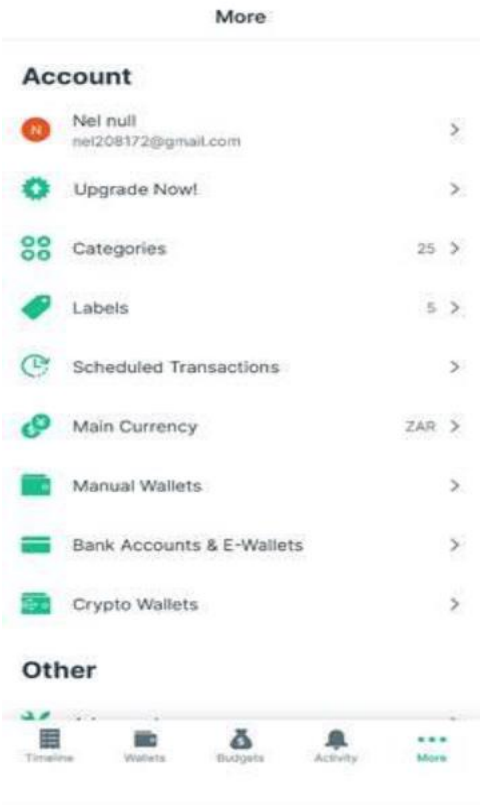


Figure 9:Account Screen

This screen includes access to Categories and Scheduled Transactions which are essential for creating and managing budgets, it supports organising expenses into defined categories to control spending.

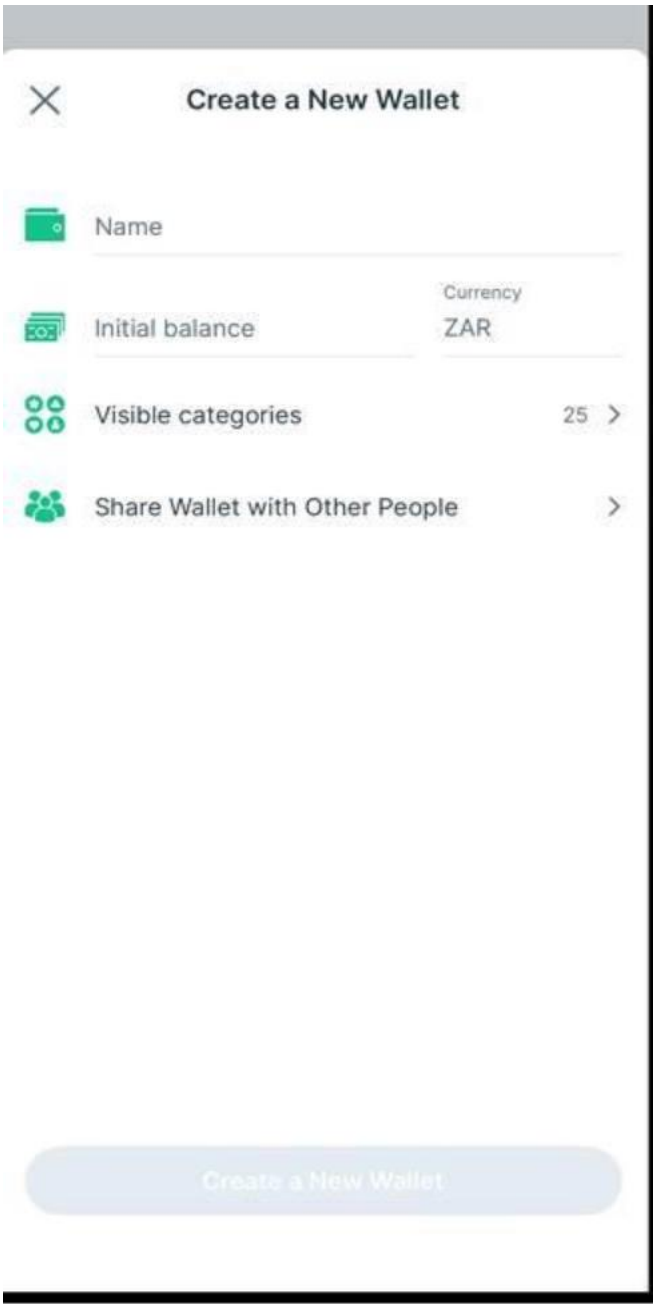


Figure 10:Adding Wallets Interface

This screen shows how you can create a new wallet. A user can opt for the “Share Wallet with Other People” feature which is specifically designed to allow multiple users to contribute and track finances in a shared space the feature however is available in the pro version.

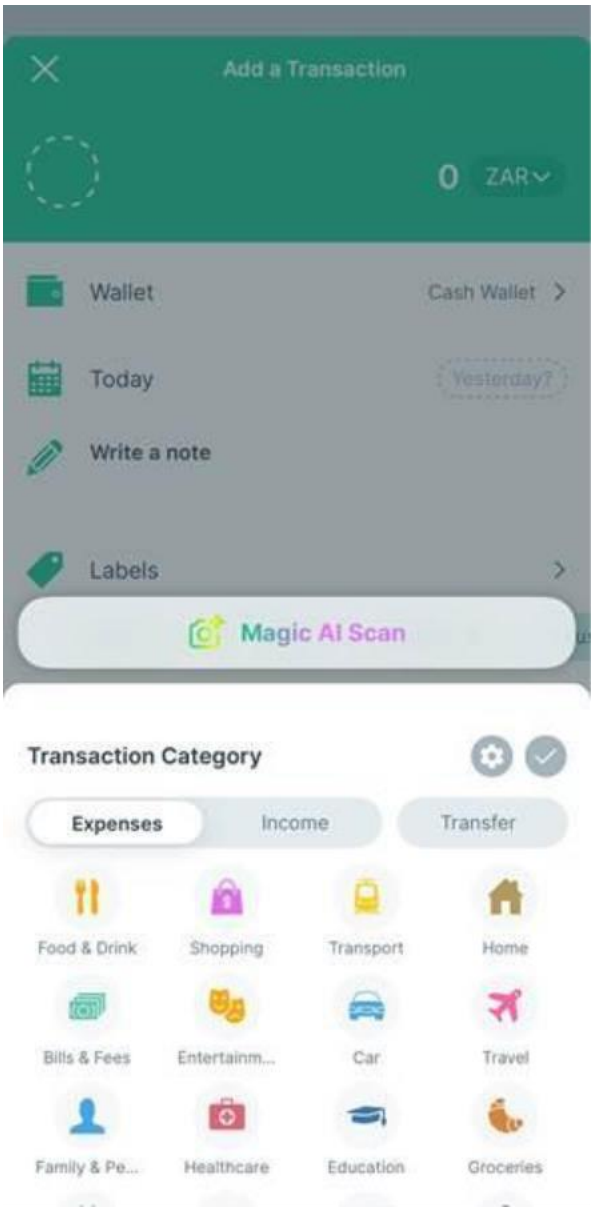


Figure 11:Entering Transaction details

This screen shows the process for adding a transaction to effortlessly track and monitor their expenses. This feature allows users to track their budgets in real time.

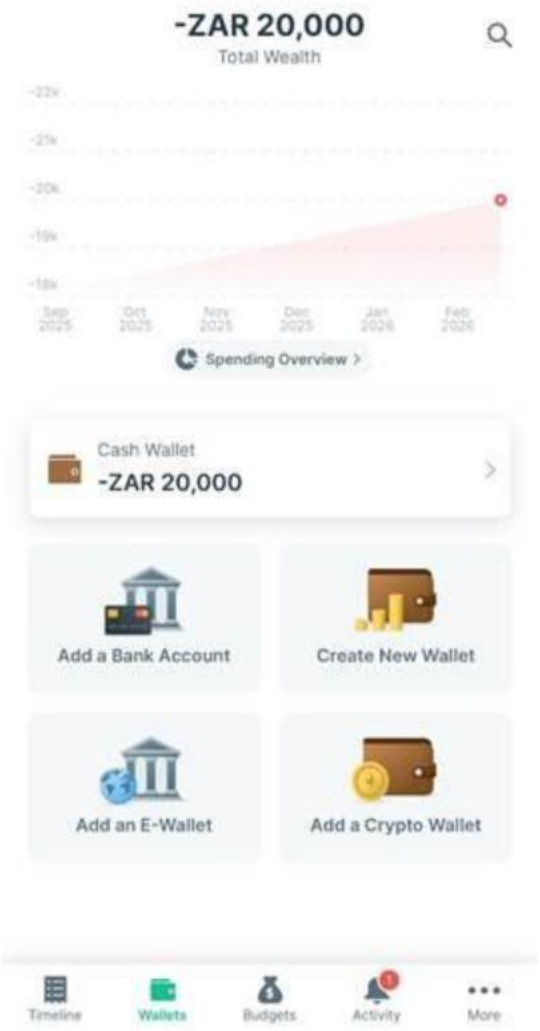


Figure 12:Wallet Analysis

The graph displaying Total Wealth and Spending Overview represents visual financial reporting, which helps users analyse trends and make informed decisions.

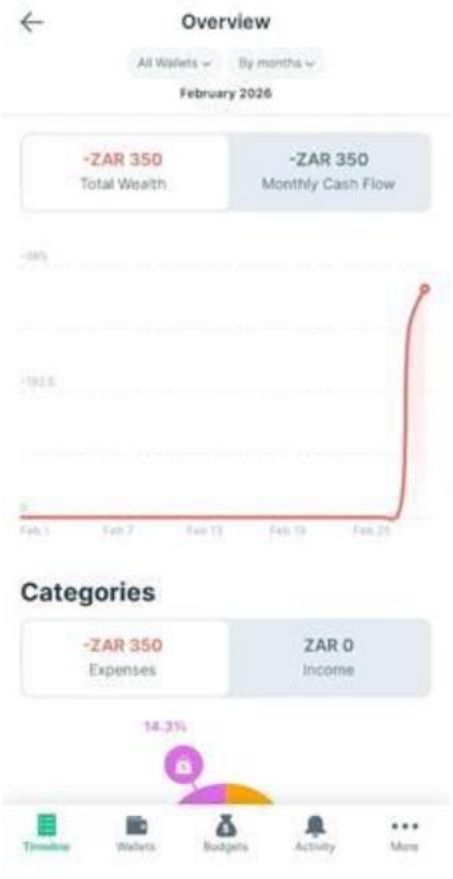


Figure 13:Overview with Line graph



Figure 14:Category Overview with Pie Chart

Spending Overview detailed analysis shows you what your spending habits are for the month and when you spent the most money displayed through graphs/charts.

Strengths

- The application features a clean, intuitive and visually appealing layout that makes managing finances feel simple and engaging rather than overwhelming (Lahiri, 2026).
- According to Lahiri (2026) new users can quickly understand and navigate the app allowing them to begin tracking and managing their finances within minutes of signing with the help of tutorials available.
- Spendee operates smoothly with minimal loading times making it convenient for users to log expenses quickly while on the go (Lahiri, 2026).

- As stated by Lahiri (2026) users can sync their bank accounts to automatically import transactions, which reduces the need for manual data entry and minimising potential errors.

Weaknesses

- The free version of the app provides only basic functionality, with several advanced tools and features restricted to paid plans (Lahiri, 2026).
- According to Lahiri (2026) key features such as shared wallets, detailed financial reporting and business-oriented tools are only available through Premium/Business subscriptions, which may not be affordable for all users.
- Lahiri (2026) states that although the app implements strong security measures, users may still have concerns about linking their bank accounts and sharing sensitive information through a third-party platform.
- Gord (2025) notes that the app's bank integration feature is not supported in all countries therefore, some users are unable to connect their local bank accounts, which limits access to automatic transaction syncing.

Innovative features

Budget Tracking

As stated by Lahiri (2026), users can set up and manage their budgets by creating specific categories that help them stay within their spending limits and maintain their better financial control.

Shared Wallets

Lahiri (2026) states that it is ideal for families or small businesses to have a feature that allows multiple users to manage and track finances together within one shared account space.

Multi-Currency Support:

According to Pavel (2021) it does not matter where you are in the world the app allows you to keep track of your monthly income and expenses. It supports a wide range of currencies, and you can switch back to your default one easily.

Expense Tracking

Transactions can be added quickly and easily, with the option to upload receipt photos for better record keeping and accuracy (Lahiri, 2026).

Financial Insights

The app presents financial data through colour coded charts, graphs and summaries which makes it easier to interpret and analyse complex information (Lahiri, 2026).

Smart Alerts:

According to Lahiri (2026) the app provides timely notifications when users approach their set budget limits which helps prevent overspending and encourages responsible financial management.

3. Cashew App

Overview

Cashew is a budget app that helps users manage their finances swiftly by entering their data manually or connecting their bank card (Lyalya, 2026). Its user-friendly interface is accompanied by having multiple ways to edit the interface in a manner users understand which positively affects user experience (Kokoska, 2025). Its main goal is to help the user set budgets, track income and expenses, and categorize them in a visually appealing dashboard (Lyalya, 2026).

Screenshots with descriptions



Figure 15:Home Screen with Spending overview

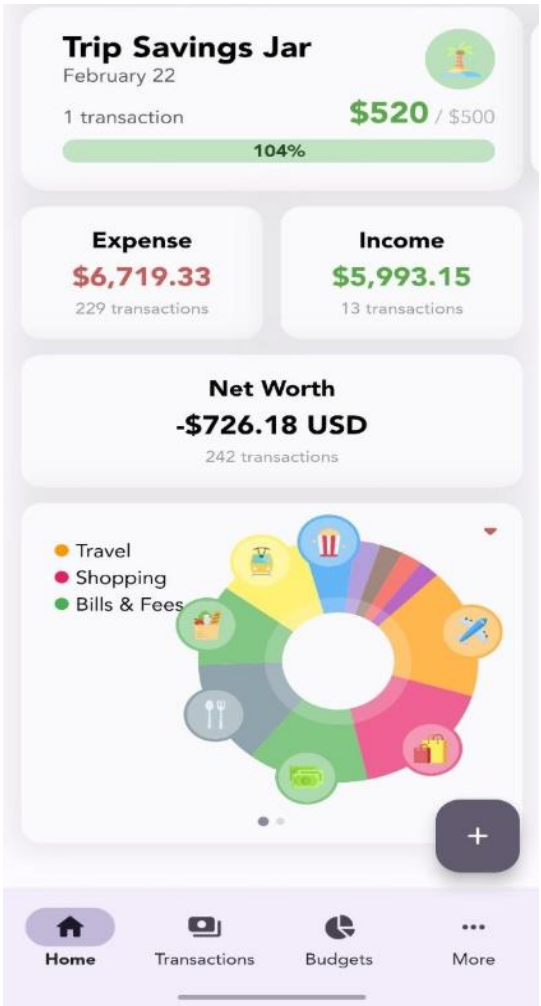


Figure 16:Expense Pie Chart

The home page displays the accounts the user has and the currency type. The first account is the primary account, and its information is further broken down into graphs. The graph can change according to what the user wants to see expenses/income respectively. User visually sees which spending categories consume their income.

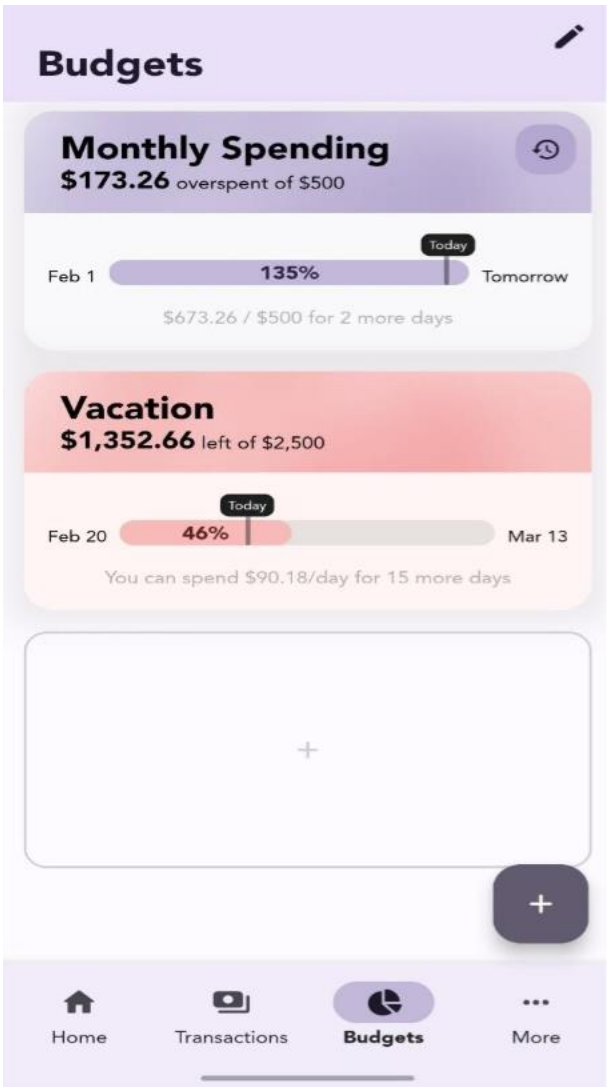


Figure 17:Budgets Screen

On the budget page, users can make multiple budget goals and limits. Shows how far users are from their goal and when they are over the planned budget, allowing the user to control their spending.

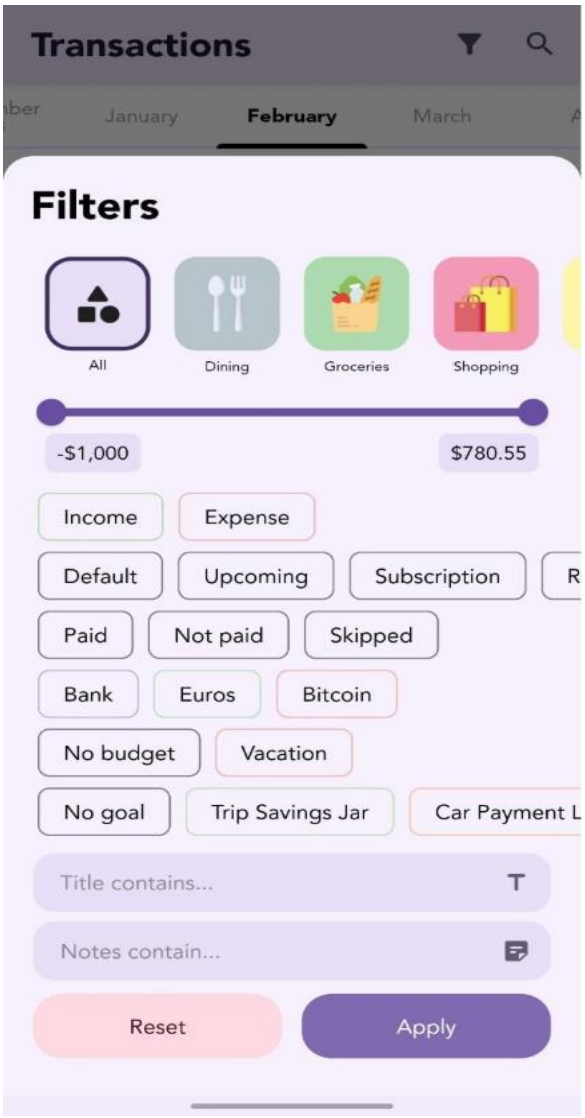


Figure 18:Transaction entry details

Users can filter out the information shown in their transaction lists, allowing them to have a focused view on their transactions. Users can enter their subscriptions so they can be billed automatically.

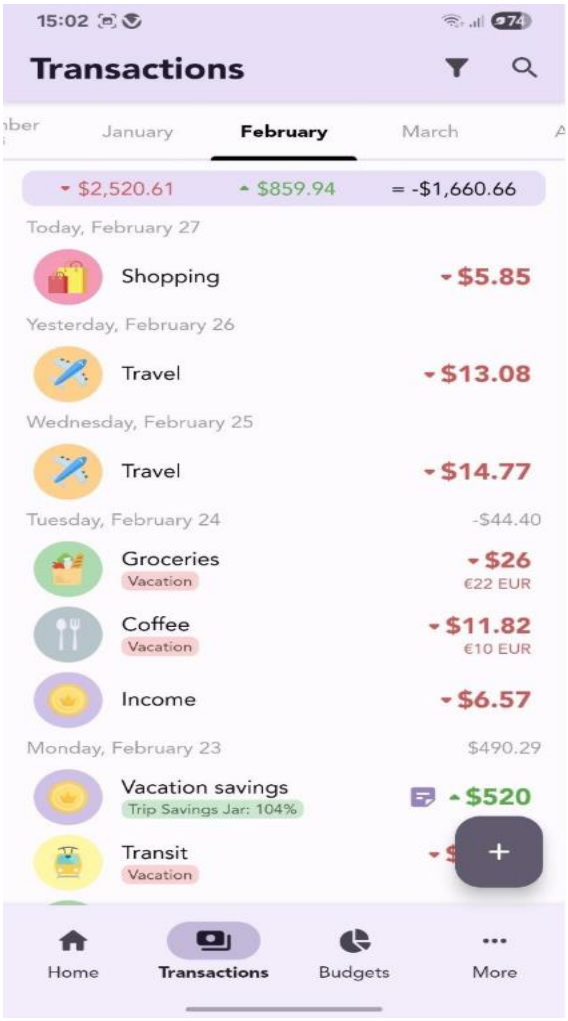


Figure 19:List of Everyday Transactions

Users can see a detailed list of all their transactions made daily. Income and expense totals are calculated to determine the net worth.

Strengths

- Simple UI; user can customize the way data is displayed (Fuel the Nerd, 2025).
- Import and Export CSV Files for seamless transition between related apps for better finance management (Fuel the Nerd, 2025).
- Easy synchronization across devices and users (Cashew, 2026). Families are able to share account data in real time(Fuel the Nerd, 2025).
- Many features are available for free. The free version is extremely functional (Fuel the Nerd, 2025).

Weaknesses

- User manually enters expenses. This can be time consuming and lead to data inconsistency in case the user forgets to record an expense (DxLoop, 2024).
- Initial setup can take some time due to goals and budgets needed to be set (Lyalya, 2026).
- Not all users can connect their bank accounts, so their transactions cannot be automatically categorized (Lyalya, 2026).

Innovative features

- **Budget Management**

  Users can add many budgets, loans, and goals; they can add limits and subscription deadlines (Kokoska, 2025). Cashew budget cards suggest to the user how to stay in budget by estimating how much they can use per day every month (Kokoska, 2025).

- **Transaction Management**

  Cashew offers multiple types of categories for types of transactions. Users can create customized categories (Cashew, 2026). Every transaction is recorded daily and can be filtered according to what the user wants.

- **Financial flexibility**
  Cashew has different currencies thus users can set up multiple accounts each with the same/different currency types (Kokoska, 2025). Cashew can convert currency type provided (Cashew, 2026).

- **Backup and Syncing**

  Budget and Transaction data are synchronized across all devices, making sure that data is consistent in a household with a shared account (Cashew, 2026). Google drive backup is in place in case data is lost unintentionally (Kokoska, 2025).

- **Smart Automation**

  User stays informed of budget deadlines, upcoming subscriptions due, and transactions through notifications (Kokoska, 2025).

Infographic

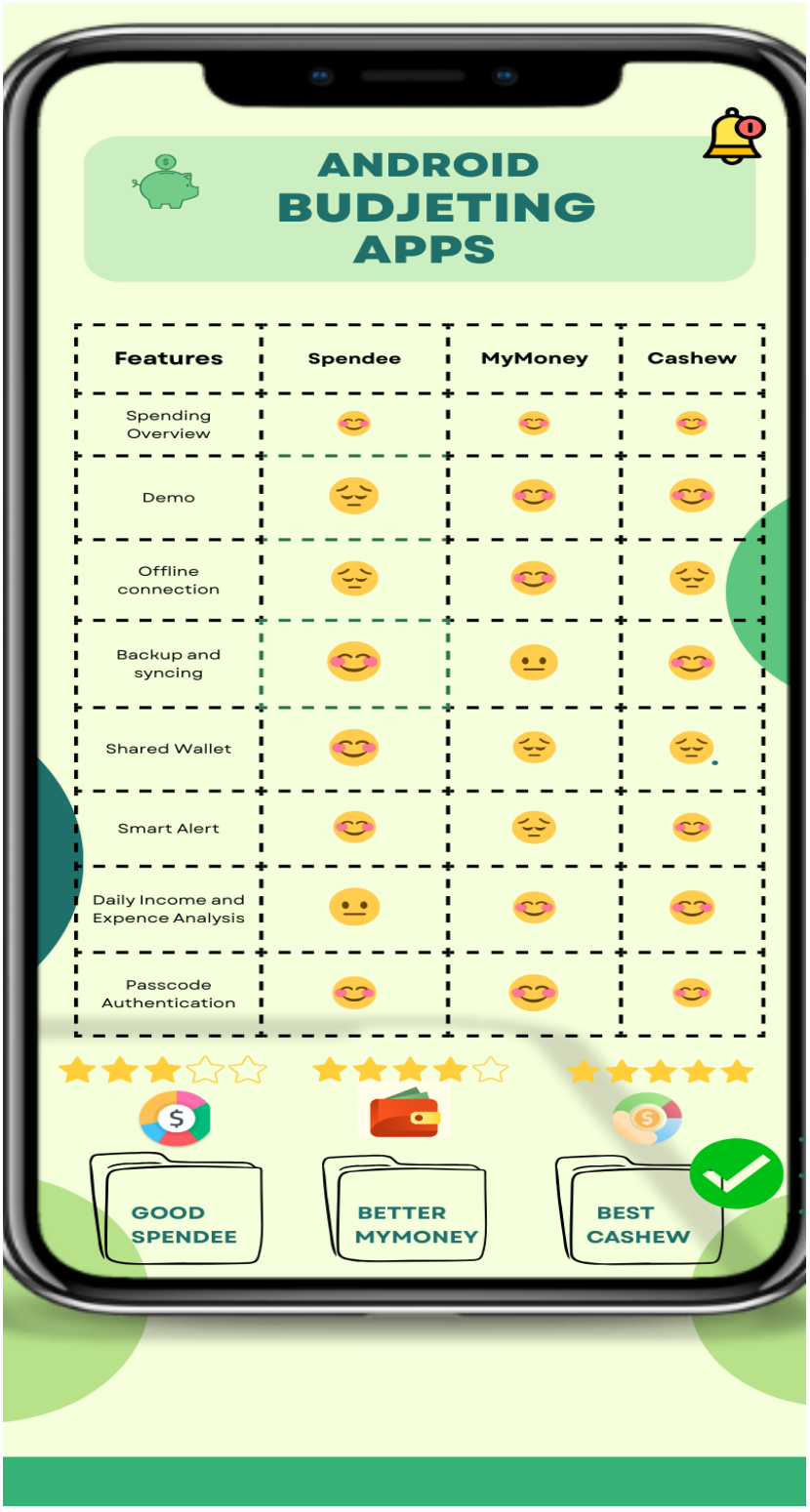


Figure 20:Infographic Image

A list of best features from:

- **MyMoney:**
  - → Daily analysis of spending and income habits displayed in graphs helps users visualize how much each category consumes (Pareek, 2022).
  - → Home page with an overview of months spending journey advancing transaction management (Weber, 2025).
  - → MyMoney offers users the choice to work offline; excellent for when users want to track their expenses without internet connection (Pareek, 2022).

- **Spendee:**
  - → Shared Wallet allows families to keep track of finances in the same account (Gord, 2025).
  - → Users can upload a document (receipt). This can help them store proof of payment (Lahiri, 2026).
  - → App is secure due to the PIN set by the user for authentication (Lahiri, 2026).

- **Cashew:**
  - → Smart automation/alerts assisting the user to be aware of budget fluctuations (Kokoska, 2025).
  - → Expenses and Income daily analysis list providing better details of how money flows like banking apps (Fuel the Nerd, 2025).
  - → Demo with dummy data to help users experience the app before signing up (Kokoska, 2025).

Conclusion

This report has demonstrated how MyMoney, Spendee, and Cashew are amazing applications with innovative features that assist users to manage their finances. Ultimately every budget app succeeds in pursing the basic requirements, but automative features that ease user experience set them apart, which has led us to conclude that Cashew is the best app due to the features that it has for free and how customization the UI increases user satisfaction. MyMoney and Spendee are good apps but can only test their full capabilities upon paying the subscriptions.

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